

Day 20 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Indian National Congress

READING MATERIAL

Fifth topic of Unit III. Real exam evidence favors founder/president-name traps (similar-sounding names swapped) and TN-specific angles on the national movement (language of political meetings, women legislators) over generic INC session-by-session history.

Q: Real exam (trap): Who is considered the 'Father of the Indian National Congress', and who was its FIRST president — was it S.N. Banerjee?

A: A.O. Hume (a retired British civil servant) is considered the Father of the INC. The first president was W.C. Bonnerjee (Womesh Chunder Bonnerjee) — NOT S.N. Banerjee (Surendranath Banerjee), a different, similarly-named contemporary leader. This name mix-up is a real, confirmed exam trap.

Q: When and where was the INC founded?

A: 1885, in Bombay.

Q: Real exam: Why did Lokmanya Tilak replace the term 'Swaraj' with 'Home Rule'?

A: Because the British government found the term 'Swaraj' highly objectionable and considered it seditious, so Tilak rebranded the same demand using the less provocative term 'Home Rule' instead.

Q: What was the 'Surat Split' (1907), and what was the 'Lucknow Pact' (1916)?

A: Surat Split (1907): the INC split into Moderate and Extremist factions at its Surat session. Lucknow Pact (1916): the Moderates and Extremists reunited, AND the INC and the Muslim League agreed to jointly demand self-government from the British.

Q: Real exam: Which party started the 'Anti-Non-Cooperation League' in the Madras Presidency?

A: The Justice Party (opposing Congress's Non-Cooperation Movement in the Madras Presidency, reflecting the Justice Party's distinct, often Congress-opposed, political stance in the Tamil region).

Q: Real exam: True or false — INC held its meetings in Tamil as well (to attract common people), while the Justice Party held meetings only in English.

A: TRUE on both counts — INC used Tamil too, to reach ordinary people, while the Justice Party's meetings were conducted in English only.

Q: Real exam: In what year was Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy elected Deputy Speaker of the (Madras) Legislature?

A: 1927.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Who is considered the 'Father of the Indian National Congress'?

A. W.C. Bonnerjee

B. A.O. Hume ✓

C. S.N. Banerjee

D. Dadabhai Naoroji

Explanation: A.O. Hume. [medium, question-bank-2025]

2. Who was the FIRST president of the Indian National Congress?

A. S.N. Banerjee

B. W.C. Bonnerjee ✓

C. Dadabhai Naoroji

D. Gopal Krishna Gokhale

Explanation: W.C. Bonnerjee — not S.N. Banerjee, a common name-confusion trap. [hard, question-bank-2025]

3. Why did Lokmanya Tilak rebrand 'Swaraj' as 'Home Rule'?

A. Swaraj had no popular support

B. The British considered 'Swaraj' seditious ✓

C. Home Rule was a Congress tradition

D. Tilak wanted an English-only slogan

Explanation: The British government found 'Swaraj' objectionable/seditious. [medium, question-bank-2026]

4. Which party started the 'Anti-Non-Cooperation League' in the Madras Presidency?

- A. Indian National Congress
- B. Communist Party
- C. Swatantra Party
- D. Justice Party ✓**

Explanation: The Justice Party. [medium, question-bank-2025]

5. Which statement is correct about political meetings in the Madras Presidency era?

- A. INC held meetings only in English
- B. Justice Party held meetings in Tamil to reach common people
- C. INC held meetings in Tamil too, to attract common people ✓**
- D. Neither party used Tamil

Explanation: INC used Tamil as well as English to reach ordinary people; the Justice Party's meetings were English-only. [medium, question-bank-2025]

6. Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy was elected Deputy Speaker of the Madras Legislature in which year?

- A. 1921
- B. 1927 ✓**
- C. 1937
- D. 1947

Explanation: 1927. [hard, question-bank-2025]

7. The INC split into Moderate and Extremist factions at which 1907 session, known as the:

- A. Lucknow Pact
- B. Surat Split ✓**
- C. Lahore Resolution
- D. Calcutta Session

Explanation: The Surat Split. [medium, authored]

8. The Indian National Congress was founded in which year and city?

- A. 1885, Bombay ✓**
- B. 1905, Calcutta
- C. 1857, Delhi
- D. 1920, Madras

Explanation: 1885, Bombay. [easy, authored]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Lowest Common Multiple (LCM)

READING MATERIAL

LCM is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows two distinct shapes: algebraic LCM-from-a-clue problems, and 'remainder' word problems — both are taught below as separate methods.

Q: Real exam (2025): If the LCM of 'a' and 'a+2' is 1300, find the LCM of 'a' and 'a+1'.

A: Since a and a+2 differ by 2, their HCF is either 1 or 2. If $\text{HCF}=2$: $\text{LCM} = a(a+2)/2 = 1300 \rightarrow a(a+2) = 2600$. Solving $a^2+2a-2600=0$ gives $a=50$ (check: $50 \times 52/2 = 1300$ ✓). Now find $\text{LCM}(50, 51)$: consecutive integers are always coprime ($\text{HCF}=1$), so $\text{LCM} = 50 \times 51 = 2550$.

Q: Method — 'least number leaving given remainders' (remainders differ from the divisors by a constant): Find the least number which, when divided by 16, 18, and 21, leaves remainders 3, 5, and 8 respectively.

A: Check the gap between each divisor and its remainder: $16-3=13$, $18-5=13$, $21-8=13$ — all the same gap! When that happens, the answer is $\text{LCM}(16,18,21) - 13$. $\text{LCM}(16,18,21) = 1008$. Answer = $1008-13 = 995$.

Q: Method — 'least number leaving the SAME remainder in every case': Find the least number which, when divided by 6, 7, 8, 9, and 12, leaves the same remainder 1 in every case.

A: When the remainder is identical across all divisors, the answer is $\text{LCM}(\text{divisors}) + \text{remainder}$. $\text{LCM}(6,7,8,9,12) = 504$. Answer = $504 + 1 = 505$.

Q: Method — 'mixed condition' (a common remainder for some divisors, but exact division for another): Find the least number which, when divided by 5, 6, 7, and 8, leaves remainder 3 in each case, but leaves NO remainder when divided by 9.

A: First find the least number leaving remainder 3 for 5,6,7,8: that's $\text{LCM}(5,6,7,8)+3 = 840+3 = 843$. But we also need it divisible by 9. Keep adding $\text{LCM}(5,6,7,8)=840$ repeatedly to 843 until the result is divisible by 9: 843 (no), 1683 ($1683 \div 9 = 187$, yes!). Answer = 1683.

Q: Method — LCM of numbers given as prime factorizations: Find the LCM of $(2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7)$ and $(3 \times 5 \times 7 \times 11)$.

A: LCM takes the HIGHEST power of every prime that appears in either number. Primes involved: 2,3,5,7,11 — each appears at most once in either factorization, so $\text{LCM} = 2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7 \times 11$ (just the union of all prime factors, since none repeat).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. If the LCM of 'b' and 'b+2' is 180, and their HCF is 2, find the LCM of 'b' and 'b+1'.

A. 342 ✓

B. 380

C. 361

D. 324

Explanation: $\text{LCM} = b(b+2)/\text{HCF} = 180 \rightarrow b(b+2) = 360 \rightarrow b^2+2b-360=0 \rightarrow b=18$ (check: $18 \times 20/2 = 180$ ✓). Now $\text{LCM}(18,19)$: consecutive integers are coprime, so $\text{LCM} = 18 \times 19 = 342$. [hard, authored]

2. Find the least number which, when divided by 12, 15, and 20, leaves remainders 7, 10, and 15 respectively.

A. 55 ✓

B. 60

C. 65

D. 53

Explanation: Gaps: $12-7=5$, $15-10=5$, $20-15=5$ — all equal, so answer = $\text{LCM}(12,15,20) - 5 = 60 - 5 = 55$. [medium, authored]

3. Find the least number which, when divided by 4, 5, and 6, leaves the same remainder 2 in each case.

A. 58

B. 60

C. 62 ✓

D. 64

Explanation: $\text{LCM}(4,5,6) = 60$. Answer = $60 + 2 = 62$. [easy, authored]

4. Find the LCM of $(2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 5)$ and $(2 \times 3 \times 3 \times 7)$.

A. $2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$ ✓

B. $2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$

C. $2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$

D. $4 \times 9 \times 5 \times 7$

Explanation: Take the highest power of each prime: 2^2 (from the first), 3^2 (from the second), 5^1 , 7^1 . $\text{LCM} = 2^2 \times 3^2 \times 5 \times 7$, which equals option (A) written out as $2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$. [medium, authored]

5. The LCM of two consecutive integers n and $n+1$ is always:

A. $n + 1$

B. $n(n+1)$ ✓

C. $n - 1$

D. Cannot be determined

Explanation: Consecutive integers are always coprime ($\text{HCF}=1$), so their LCM is simply their product, $n(n+1)$. [easy, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "The Comet" — Norman Littleford

READING MATERIAL

A science-flavoured poem describing a comet's speed, size, and the science of its glowing tail. Real coaching-site evidence tests figure-of-speech identification heavily, plus the underlying science content (ice melting into vapour forming the tail).

Q: Who wrote "The Comet", and what is the poem broadly about?

A: Norman Littleford. The poem describes a comet's speed and size, the science of how its tail forms (ice melting into vapour as it nears the sun), the potential danger if a comet came too close to Earth (atmospheric shockwaves, earthquakes), and even touches the scientific idea that cometary dust chemicals may have contributed to the origins of life.

Q: What is the poem's structure (stanzas, lines, rhyme scheme)?

A: Six stanzas of four lines each, rhyme scheme ABCB.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Rampaging through the heavens."

A: Cited as BOTH Personification (the comet given the active, almost violent human/animal action of 'rampaging') and Imagery (a vivid visual impression) in different sourced questions — both labels are defensible for the same line, so be ready for either framing.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Faster than a cheetah."

A: Simile — direct comparison using 'than' (the comparative form of 'like/as').

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "A comet in full flight."

A: Metaphor — describes the comet's motion directly as 'flight' without 'like/as'.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "With a tail that's miles long."

A: Hyperbole — an exaggerated claim about the tail's length, for dramatic emphasis.

Q: Which line is the clearest example of hyperbole, among 'Bigger than a mountain', 'So powerful and strong', 'Causing vapor from the force', and 'The outer ice is melting'?

A: "Bigger than a mountain" — an exaggerated size comparison, the others are more literal/descriptive statements.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Comet" is structured as how many stanzas, and what rhyme scheme?

A. 4 stanzas, AABB

B. 6 stanzas, ABCB ✓

C. 8 stanzas, ABAB

D. 6 stanzas, AABB

Explanation: Six stanzas of four lines, ABCB rhyme scheme. [hard, web-research]

2. "Faster than a cheetah" uses which figure of speech?

A. Metaphor

B. Simile ✓

C. Personification

D. Hyperbole

Explanation: Simile — comparison using 'than'. [easy, web-research]

3. "A comet in full flight" is an example of:

A. Simile

B. Metaphor ✓

C. Hyperbole

D. Personification

Explanation: Metaphor — motion described directly as 'flight'. [medium, web-research]

4. "With a tail that's miles long" uses which figure of speech?

A. Simile

B. Metaphor

C. Hyperbole ✓

D. Personification

Explanation: Hyperbole — exaggerated for emphasis. [medium, web-research]

5. According to the poem, what causes the comet's glowing tail to form?

A. Reflected starlight

B. Ice melting into vapour ✓

C. Magnetic radiation

D. Friction with the solar wind

Explanation: The outer ice melts into vapour, trailing behind as the tail. [medium, web-research]

6. Which of these lines is the clearest example of hyperbole?

A. Bigger than a mountain ✓

B. So powerful and strong

C. Causing vapor from the force

D. The outer ice is melting

Explanation: "Bigger than a mountain" — an exaggerated size claim. [medium, web-research]